YouTube Growth Plan: Detailed Month-by-Month Execution Guide

Prepared: April 1, 2026 **For:** Dave & Kelly — Big Beach AL / AntiGravity Projects

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Pre-Launch Checklist (Complete Before Filming Anything)

Channel Setup (Day 1-2)

- [ ] Create or claim YouTube channel
- [ ] Set custom handle (e.g., @BigBeachAL — short, memorable, brandable)
- [ ] Write channel description (250+ words, keyword-loaded):

> "Your insider guide to living on Alabama's Gulf Coast. We cover Gulf Shores, Orange Beach, Fairhope, Daphne, Spanish Fort, Foley, and all of Baldwin County, Alabama. Whether you're moving to the Gulf Coast, investing in beach condos, or just dreaming about the beach life — we've got you covered. New videos every Monday, Wednesday, and Friday. Subscribe for relocation guides, condo tours, restaurant reviews, market updates, and the real story of what it's like to live here year-round."

- [ ] Add links: website, Instagram, Facebook, email, phone
- [ ] Set channel keywords in YouTube Studio > Settings > Channel: "Gulf Shores Alabama, Orange Beach Alabama, living in Gulf Shores, moving to Alabama, Baldwin County real estate, beach condos Alabama, Gulf Coast living"

Branding Assets (Day 2-3)

- [ ] Channel profile photo — professional headshot or logo (800x800px)
- [ ] Channel banner — you + the beach + tagline (2560x1440px, safe area 1546x423px)
  - Include: posting schedule ("New videos Mon/Wed/Fri"), social handles, tagline
- [ ] Create 3-4 thumbnail templates in Canva:
  - **Template A — "Moving To" videos**: Beach background, your face (reaction), bold location text

  - **Template B — Property/Condo tours**: Property photo, your face, "TOUR" or price text
  - **Template C — Lifestyle/Local**: Vibrant food/sunset/event photo, text overlay
  - **Template D — Market/Data**: Chart graphic, concerned/excited face, numbers
- [ ] Channel trailer script (60-90 seconds — film this on the beach):

> "Hey, I'm [Name] and this is [Channel Name]. If you've ever thought about moving to Alabama's Gulf Coast — Gulf Shores, Orange Beach, Fairhope, or anywhere in Baldwin County — you're in the right place. Every week we do condo tours, restaurant reviews, neighborhood guides, and honest talk about what it's actually like to live here. Not the tourist version — the real deal. Hit subscribe and I'll see you in the next one."

Equipment Purchases (Day 1-3)

- [ ] DJI Mini 4 Pro drone (~$760) — this is the #1 differentiator vs. competitors
- [ ] Wireless mic: DJI Mic 2 (~~$250) or Rode Wireless Go II~~ ($300)
- [ ] Small LED light panel for indoor shots (~$30-50, Amazon)
- [ ] Phone tripod/gimbal: DJI OM 7 (~~$150) or basic tripod~~ ($25)
- [ ] Install editing software: CapCut (free, great for beginners) or DaVinci Resolve (free, more powerful)
- [ ] Install TubeBuddy or VidIQ browser extension (free tier)
- [ ] Create Canva account (free tier works, Pro is $13/month)

Content Planning (Day 3-4)

- [ ] Research keywords with TubeBuddy/VidIQ for your first 12 videos
- [ ] Scout filming locations for Week 1 videos
- [ ] Create a shared Google Sheet or Notion board for content calendar
- [ ] Set up a "B-roll library" folder — start filming beach sunsets, drone shots, downtown walks anytime you're out

Total setup investment: ~$1,000-1,300 + your time

MONTH 1: Foundation & Launch (Weeks 1-4)

Week 1: Launch Week

Goal: Publish 3 long-form videos + channel trailer. Establish your presence.

DAY	CONTENT	TYPE	DETAILS
Mon	Channel Trailer	Trailer	60-90 sec, film on the beach. Pin to channel homepage.
Mon	"Moving to Gulf Shores Alabama — Everything You Need to Know (2026)"	Long-form (12-18 min)	THE most important video. Cover: location, weather, cost of living, neighborhoods, schools, jobs, lifestyle, pros/cons. Film on location at 3-4 spots around Gulf Shores. Open with drone shot of the beach.
Wed	"Moving to Orange Beach Alabama — Complete Guide (2026)"	Long-form (12-18 min)	Same format as Gulf Shores video but for Orange Beach. Different locations, different vibe. Mention how it differs from Gulf Shores.
Fri	"Gulf Shores vs Orange Beach — Which is Right For You?"	Long-form (10-15 min)	Comparison format. Split-screen footage. Cover: price, vibe, amenities, dining, beach quality, investment potential. This is a high-search-volume topic.

Shorts this week (optional — focus on long-form first):

- Tue: 30-sec drone montage "This is Gulf Shores" (set to trending audio)
- Thu: 60-sec "3 things that surprised me about living on the Gulf Coast"

Filming tips for Week 1:

- Batch film all 3 videos in 1-2 days if possible
- Start each video with a hook (first 5 seconds): "If you're thinking about moving to Gulf Shores, there are 7 things you absolutely need to know first."
- Film drone B-roll at golden hour (sunrise or 1 hour before sunset)
- Get 5-10 minutes of "walking around" B-roll at each location to cut to while talking
- Film yourself driving into town (dashcam POV) for establishing shots

Upload optimization checklist (every video):

- [ ] Title: Location first, year, emotional hook
- [ ] Description: 250+ words, first 2 lines are the hook (this shows in search), include all relevant city names, link to your website and socials, timestamps for key sections
- [ ] Tags: 15-20 tags (TubeBuddy will suggest these)

- [ ] Thumbnail: Use your template, test 2 versions if possible
- [ ] End screen: Subscribe button + link to related video
- [ ] Cards: Link to related videos at relevant moments
- [ ] Pinned comment: "Thinking about moving to the Gulf Coast? [Link to free guide or your contact info]"
- [ ] First comment reply: Answer any question within 24 hours

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Week 2: Cost of Living & Lifestyle

Goal: 3 more long-form videos. Start building your lifestyle differentiator.

DAY	CONTENT	TYPE	DETAILS
Mon	"Cost of Living in Gulf Shores Alabama — Real Numbers (2026)"	Long-form (10-15 min)	Housing costs, utilities, groceries, insurance (flood/wind!), property taxes, dining out, gas. Show actual screenshots of Zillow listings, utility bills, grocery receipts. Be specific and honest.
Wed	"Best Restaurants in Gulf Shores — Local Favorites, Not Tourist Traps"	Long-form (12-18 min)	Visit 5-7 restaurants. Film the food, the atmosphere, quick interview with owners if they're cool with it. THIS is your lifestyle differentiator — nobody else does this.
Fri	"10 Things I Wish I Knew Before Moving to the Alabama Gulf Coast"	Long-form (12-15 min)	Listicle format. Cover: hurricane season reality, humidity, snowbird traffic, off-season quiet, insurance costs, job market, "it's not just a vacation," etc. Honest, relatable, shareable.

Shorts:

- Tue: "The BEST shrimp po'boy in Gulf Shores" (60 sec, film at restaurant)
- Thu: "What $400K gets you in Gulf Shores vs [other city]" (side-by-side)
- Sat: Drone sunset timelapse (15-30 sec, set to music)

Key focus this week: The restaurant video is your secret weapon. It's lifestyle content that:

1. Local businesses will share with THEIR audiences (free promotion)
2. People planning vacations will watch (broader audience than just relocators)
3. Shows you know the area deeply (builds trust)
4. Is more fun and shareable than pure real estate content

Week 3: Property Content & Fairhope

Goal: Start covering specific properties and expand to Fairhope.

DAY	CONTENT	TYPE	DETAILS
Mon	"Best Condo Complexes in Orange Beach — Top 5 Ranked"	Long-form (15-20 min)	Visit and film 5 condo complexes. Drone shots of each. Cover: price range, amenities, rental potential, HOA fees, beach access, pool, views. This is Jeff Nelson's territory — match his depth but with better production.
Wed	"Moving to Fairhope Alabama — Why Everyone's Moving Here (2026)"	Long-form (12-18 min)	Fairhope is a different market (artsy downtown, bay not beach, family-oriented). Film downtown, the pier, the shops, the neighborhoods.
Fri	"Google Map Tour of Gulf Shores Alabama — Virtual Neighborhood Guide"	Long-form (15-20 min)	Andy Hollis's signature format. Screen-record Google Maps, walk through neighborhoods, overlay with your commentary and actual photos/drone footage of each area. Do it BETTER by adding real footage.

Shorts:

- Tue: "This condo has the BEST pool in Orange Beach" (60 sec tour)
- Thu: Quick Fairhope downtown walking clip
- Sat: "Would you live here?" — show a stunning condo view

Week 4: Pros/Cons, Investment, and Your First Series Episode

Goal: Round out your foundation content. Launch your first named series.

DAY	CONTENT	TYPE	DETAILS
Mon	"Pros and Cons of Living in Gulf Shores Alabama — Honest Take"	Long-form (10-15 min)	Be genuinely honest. Pros: beach life, low taxes, friendly people, affordable (vs FL). Cons: hurricane risk, humidity, limited job market, tourist crowds in summer, flood insurance. Honesty builds trust.
Wed	"Is a Gulf Shores Condo a Good Investment in 2026?"	Long-form (12-15 min)	Data-driven. Average rental income, occupancy rates, HOA costs, appreciation trends, insurance costs, management fees. Use screen grabs of AirDNA or similar data. Position yourself as the analytical expert.
Fri	**"Beach House Breakdown #1"** — [Specific Property/Complex]	Long-form (10-15 min)	LAUNCH YOUR FIRST NAMED SERIES. Tour a specific property or condo. Give your honest take on value, layout, investment potential, what you'd change. Make it a recurring format people look forward to.

Shorts:

- Tue: "How much can you make renting a Gulf Shores condo?" (60 sec, data overlay)
- Thu: "POV: Your morning commute lives on the Gulf Coast" (beach driving footage)
- Sat: Behind-the-scenes of filming a video (builds connection)

Month 1 Totals

- **12 long-form videos** published
- **8-12 Shorts** published
- **Expected results:** 50-300 subscribers, 1,000-3,000 total views
- **Don't panic if numbers are low.** Andy Hollis got zero leads for 4 months. The algorithm needs time to understand your channel.

MONTH 2: Expand & Refine (Weeks 5-8)

Strategy Shift

You now have a foundation. Month 2 is about:

1. Expanding geographic coverage (Daphne, Spanish Fort, Foley)
2. Launching your second named series ("Gulf Coast Insider")
3. Starting local business collaborations
4. Analyzing what's working and doubling down

Week 5

DAY	CONTENT	TYPE
Mon	"Moving to Daphne Alabama — The Best Kept Secret on the Gulf Coast"	Long-form
Wed	**"Gulf Coast Insider #1"** — Best Coffee Shops on the Alabama Gulf Coast	Long-form (SERIES LAUNCH)
Fri	"Best Condo Complexes in Gulf Shores — Top 5 Ranked"	Long-form

Week 6

DAY	CONTENT	TYPE
Mon	"Moving to Spanish Fort Alabama — Complete Guide (2026)"	Long-form
Wed	"Beach House Breakdown #2" — [New Property]	Long-form (series)
Fri	"What Living on the Gulf Coast is ACTUALLY Like — Day in the Life"	Long-form (lifestyle)

Week 7

DAY	CONTENT	TYPE
Mon	"Moving to Foley Alabama — Affordable Gulf Coast Living"	Long-form
Wed	"Gulf Coast Insider #2" — Best Seafood on the Alabama Gulf Coast	Long-form (series)
Fri	"Google Map Tour of Orange Beach Alabama"	Long-form

Week 8

DAY	CONTENT	TYPE
Mon	"Fairhope vs Daphne — Which Eastern Shore Town is Right For You?"	Long-form
Wed	"Beach House Breakdown #3" — [New Property]	Long-form (series)
Fri	**"Market Minute #1"** — Gulf Coast Real Estate Market Update April 2026	Long-form (SERIES LAUNCH)

Month 2 Actions

- [ ] Reach out to 5 local restaurants/businesses about being featured
- [ ] Start collecting email addresses via free relocation guide
- [ ] Review YouTube Studio analytics — which videos get the most:
  - Search impressions? (make more like those)
  - Watch time? (study what keeps people engaged)
  - Click-through rate? (your best thumbnails — replicate them)
- [ ] Engage in comments on competitor videos (genuinely helpful, not spammy)
- [ ] Share videos in relevant Facebook groups (Gulf Shores relocation, Baldwin County, etc.)

Month 2 Totals

- **12 more long-form videos** (24 total)
- **3 named series established** (Beach House Breakdown, Gulf Coast Insider, Market Minute)
- **Expected results:** 300-1,000 subscribers, 5,000-15,000 monthly views

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MONTH 3: Accelerate & Convert (Weeks 9-12)

Strategy Shift

Month 3 is about:

1. Converting viewers into leads
2. Seasonal/timely content
3. Collaboration videos going live
4. Starting to build the content moat (specific complexes, neighborhoods)

Content Calendar

WEEK	MON	WED	FRI
9	"Hurricane Season on the Gulf Coast — What You REALLY Need to Know"	Gulf Coast Insider #3 — Best Date Night Spots	Beach House Breakdown #4
10	"Buying Your First Beach Condo — Step by Step Guide"	"[Local Business Owner] Shows Us the REAL Gulf Shores" (COLLAB)	"Summer in Gulf Shores — What to Expect"
11	"Turquoise Place Orange Beach — Complete Condo Tour & Review"	Gulf Coast Insider #4 — Hidden Beaches Only Locals Know	Market Minute #2 — May 2026 Update
12	"Phoenix West Orange Beach — Condo Tour & Investment Breakdown"	Beach House Breakdown #5	"3 Months on YouTube: Honest Results (What Worked, What Didn't)"

Month 3 Actions

- [ ] Set up lead magnet: Free "Gulf Coast Relocation Guide" PDF (email gate)
- [ ] Add UTM-tagged links to video descriptions to track leads
- [ ] Film 2-3 collaboration videos with local businesses
- [ ] Create a "Start Here" playlist for new channel visitors
- [ ] Update channel trailer if you have better footage now
- [ ] Begin pitching to local Facebook groups as a resource (not self-promotion)

Month 3 Totals

- **12 more long-form videos** (36 total)
- **Named series running consistently** (viewers know what to expect)
- **Expected results:** 1,000-2,500 subscribers, 15,000-50,000 monthly views, first inbound leads

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MONTHS 4-6: The Moat & The Machine

By now your channel has a rhythm. Here's what changes:

Content Moat Building

Start systematically covering every searchable topic. Create a spreadsheet:

Condo Complexes (one video each):

- Turquoise Place ✓ (Month 3)
- Phoenix West ✓ (Month 3)
- Caribe Resort
- The Beach Club
- Brett/Robinson complexes
- Perdido Beach Resort
- The Palms
- Summerchase
- San Carlos
- Phoenix on the Bay
- Wind Drift
- And 20+ more...

Neighborhoods (one video each):

- Gulf Shores downtown
- Fort Morgan
- Cotton Bayou
- Ono Island
- Bear Point
- Orange Beach waterfront
- Each Fairhope neighborhood
- Each Daphne neighborhood
- Each Spanish Fort neighborhood

"Vs" Comparisons:

- Gulf Shores vs Destin
- Orange Beach vs Panama City Beach
- Fairhope vs Daphne
- Baldwin County vs Mobile County
- Alabama Gulf Coast vs Florida Gulf Coast

Repurpose Machine

By Month 4, every long-form video should generate:

- 2-3 YouTube Shorts
- 1 Instagram Reel
- 1 TikTok
- 1 blog post (on your website — massive SEO value)
- 1 Facebook post
- 1 email newsletter mention

Monthly Recurring Content

- **Market Minute** — 1st Friday of every month
- **Beach House Breakdown** — every other Wednesday
- **Gulf Coast Insider** — every other Wednesday (alternating with Beach House)

MONTHS 7-12: Domination Mode

Target Metrics by Month 12

METRIC	TARGET
Subscribers	5,000-10,000
Monthly views	50,000-150,000
Total videos	150+
Monthly inbound leads	10-30
Email list	1,000-3,000

Advanced Strategies to Deploy

1. **YouTube ads on competitor searches** — Run small ($5-10/day) YouTube ads targeting people searching for your competitors' names or "moving to Gulf Shores." Your better-produced content will convert.

2. **Live streams** — Monthly live Q&A: "Ask Me Anything About Moving to the Gulf Coast." Live streams get algorithmic priority and build community.

3. **Guest appearances on other channels** — Reach out to Florida Gulf Coast channels, general real estate channels, or travel channels for cross-promotion.

4. **"Where are they now?" follow-ups** — Interview people who moved to the area after watching your videos. Incredible social proof.

5. **Seasonal content calendar** — Plan content around:
    - Jan-Feb: "Why locals love the off-season"
    - Mar-Apr: "Spring on the Gulf Coast" + Mardi Gras content
    - May-Jun: "Summer guide" + rental income content
    - Jul-Aug: "Best of summer" + hurricane prep
    - Sep-Oct: "The secret best months" + Shrimp Festival
    - Nov-Dec: "Holidays on the coast" + year-end market recaps

6. **Podcast launch** — Once you have 100+ videos and a following, launch a companion podcast. The Short Term Shop proved the podcast + YouTube combo is powerful.

The Non-Negotiable Rules

1. **Never miss a posting day.** 3x/week minimum. Consistency beats everything.
2. **First 5 seconds hook.** If you don't grab them immediately, they're gone.
3. **Reply to every comment within 24 hours.** This is how you build community AND signal engagement to the algorithm.
4. **Film B-roll constantly.** Every time you're at the beach, a restaurant, driving around — film 30 seconds. You'll use it all.
5. **Check analytics weekly.** Know your numbers. Double down on what works.
6. **Don't chase viral.** Chase search traffic. Viral fades in 48 hours. Search compounds forever.
7. **Be patient through the dead zone.** Months 1-4 will feel like shouting into the void. This is where every competitor quit. Push through it.
8. **Be genuinely honest.** Talk about hurricanes, humidity, insurance costs, tourist traffic. Honesty is what separates you from every agent who only talks about sunsets.
9. **Every video should answer a question someone is actually Googling.** If you can't identify the search query, don't make the video.

10. **The goal is leads, not subscribers.** 500 subscribers who are actively considering a move are worth more than 50,000 subscribers who just like beach videos.

Quick Reference: Video Formula

Structure for Every Long-Form Video

```
0:00 – HOOK (5–10 sec)
       "If you're thinking about moving to [City], there are [X] things you need to know

0:10 – INTRO (15–30 sec)
       Quick channel intro, subscribe reminder. Keep it fast.

0:30 – CONTENT (8–15 min)
       Deliver the goods. Use location footage, drone shots, screen grabs.
       Break into clear sections with on-screen text.

X:00 – PERSONAL TAKE (1–2 min)
       "Here's what I honestly think…" – this is where you build trust.

X:00 – CTA (15–30 sec)
       "If you're serious about making the move, I put together a free
       relocation guide – link's in the description. And if you found this
       helpful, hit subscribe – we put out new Gulf Coast content every
       Monday, Wednesday, and Friday. See you in the next one."
```

Thumbnail Formula

```
[Your face – expressive]  +  [Location/property photo]  +  [3–5 word text overlay]
                                                              Bold, readable at
                                                              phone-screen size
```

Description Template

```
[2-line hook that shows in search results]

In this video, I cover [topic] including:
- [Timestamp] [Section 1]
- [Timestamp] [Section 2]
- [Timestamp] [Section 3]
 ...

FREE Gulf Coast Relocation Guide: [link]
Book a Free Consultation: [link]
Website: [link]

Follow us:
Instagram: [link]
Facebook: [link]
TikTok: [link]

About [Channel Name]:
[2-3 sentences about your channel, loaded with keywords: Gulf Shores,
Orange Beach, Fairhope, Baldwin County, Alabama Gulf Coast, real estate,
relocation, condos, beach living]

#GulfShores #OrangeBeach #Alabama #GulfCoast #MovingToAlabama #BeachLife
#BaldwinCounty #Fairhope #RealEstate #GulfShoresAlabama
```

Budget Summary

One-Time Costs

ITEM	COST
DJI Mini 4 Pro drone	~$760
Wireless mic (DJI Mic 2)	~$250
LED light panel	~$40
Tripod	~$25
Total	**~$1,075**

Monthly Recurring Costs

ITEM	COST
Canva Pro (optional)	$13/month
TubeBuddy/VidIQ Pro (optional)	$8-10/month
Gas for filming locations	~$50-100/month
Total	**~$70-120/month**

ROI Context

Andy Hollis closed $60M+ in real estate from YouTube with zero ad spend. Even one closed condo transaction ($300-500K) would return 100x+ on your total YouTube investment. The math on this is absurd.

This plan was built by analyzing 6 competitors in the Gulf Shores / Orange Beach / Baldwin County YouTube space. The market is wide open. Let's take it.